

YouTube upload sheet: George H. Thomas

thomas-1080p.mp4 · 18:50 · 1080p · -14.8 LUFS (master: <https://gofile.io/d/7QPAmOoq>) · written with research/PACKAGING_GUIDE.md



A (main): thumbnail.png



B: thumbnail_B.png



C: thumbnail_C.png

Title (locked, vidIQ score 91)

Grant Almost Fired Him Days Before He Crushed an Army: George Thomas's Top 3 Tactical Moves

91 of 100 characters.

Alternative titles (for Test & compare)

The Union General Grant Almost Fired, Days Before He Destroyed an Entire Army (vidIQ 91)

Grant Almost Fired Him, Then He Destroyed an Army: George Thomas's Top 3 Tactical Moves (vidIQ 90)

Half the Army Ran. One Virginian Stayed: George Thomas's Top 3 Tactical Moves (vidIQ 86)

Upload settings

Category	Education
Audience	No, it's not made for kids
Language	English
Altered or synthetic content	Yes: AI-generated narration voice (Kokoro TTS). Maps are animations; paintings are real historical artworks.
Licence	Standard YouTube Licence
Thumbnail test	Studio → Test & compare: upload all thumbnail options
Business email	Replace [email to fill in] in the description before publishing

Description (copy everything in the box)

George H. Thomas held the line at Chickamauga after a third of the Union army ran from the field. Fifteen months later, days before Ulysses Grant could relieve him of command, he broke John Bell Hood's army at Nashville.

He was a Virginian from the same state as Robert E. Lee, and when Virginia left the Union in 1861 he stayed loyal to his oath. His own sisters turned his portrait to the wall and never spoke to him again. On 20 September 1863, one confusing order opened a quarter-mile gap in the Union line at Chickamauga, Longstreet's column poured through it, and the army commander rode back to Chattanooga convinced everything was lost. Thomas gathered the fragments on Horseshoe Ridge and held until dusk.

This mini documentary breaks down the three moves that made Thomas "the Rock of Chickamauga": the stand on Horseshoe Ridge, the charge up Missionary Ridge that nobody ordered, and the hammer blow at Nashville. Then it follows him to the end, when he refused to write his memoirs and history nearly forgot him.

Three campaigns, one method. Refuse to be hurried. Hold the ground that matters. Strike to destroy, not just to defeat.

WHAT THIS EPISODE COVERS

- The Virginian who chose the Union, and the family that disowned him
- The order to "close up on Reynolds" and the gap it opened
- Horseshoe Ridge, Steedman's march to the guns, and the name "the Rock"
- The siege of Chattanooga and "We will hold the town till we starve"
- Brown's Ferry and the Cracker Line
- Grant's order to take the rifle pits and halt, and why the men kept climbing
- "I don't know. I did not." and the dead ground below the crest
- Franklin, Hood's march on Nashville, and the ice storm of December 1864
- The order relieving Thomas, and "I shall submit without a murmur"
- The feint, the great wheel, and the fall of Shy's Hill
- Why Thomas was called "Slow Trot", and why Hood misread him

CHAPTERS

- 0:00 Half the Union army breaks
- 0:47 The Virginian who stayed loyal
- 2:02 Move 1: Chickamauga
- 3:46 One order opens a quarter-mile gap
- 4:53 Horseshoe Ridge: the Rock
- 7:37 Move 2: Chattanooga under siege
- 9:37 Take the rifle pits, then halt
- 10:24 The charge nobody ordered
- 12:52 Move 3: Hood invades Tennessee
- 14:07 The ice storm and the order to fire him
- 15:27 The great wheel at Nashville
- 17:50 Legacy

RESEARCH AND SOURCES

Figures and quotations in this script were drawn from the following:

- Peter Cozzens, *This Terrible Sound: The Battle of Chickamauga*
- Peter Cozzens, *The Shipwreck of Their Hopes: The Battles for Chattanooga*
- Wiley Sword, *The Confederacy's Last Hurrah: Spring Hill, Franklin, and Nashville*
- Christopher J. Einolf, *George Thomas: Virginian for the Union*
- James M. McPherson, *Battle Cry of Freedom*
- National Park Service (Chickamauga and Chattanooga National Military Park) and the American Battlefield Trust

A NOTE ON THE NUMBERS

Chickamauga cost the Union about 16,170 casualties and the Confederates about 18,454. For Missionary Ridge the video uses the totals for the whole Chattanooga fighting (Union about 5,800; Confederate about 6,700, over 4,000 of them captured), because figures for the charge alone vary between sources. Nashville figures are approximate: about 3,000 Union and about 6,000 Confederate losses, most of them prisoners. The claim that Thomas "never lost a battle he commanded" is a popular one and is presented as such; at Chickamauga he was a corps commander in a battle the Union lost. His nickname "Slow Trot" came from his West Point cadets, whom he would not let gallop the academy's worn-out horses, not from a later injury.

CREDITS

Images: public-domain photographs and lithographs from the Library of Congress, the National Archives and Wikimedia Commons (Mathew Brady studio, George N. Barnard, A. S. Morse, Kurz & Allison, Cosack & Co.).
Terrain: Mapzen / AWS Terrain Tiles (open data).

Photo: George H. Thomas's grave, Oakwood Cemetery, Troy NY, by Matt Wade, CC BY-SA 3.0 (Wikimedia Commons).

Music: "Heavy Heart", "Clash Defiant", "Crusade", "Undaunted" by Kevin MacLeod (incompetech), licensed under Creative Commons Attribution 3.0

Music: "Ready Aim Fire" by Kevin MacLeod (incompetech), licensed under Creative Commons Attribution 4.0

Sound effects: original. Narration voice: AI-generated (Kokoro TTS). Maps: original animations.

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Which of the three do you rate highest: Horseshoe Ridge, Missionary Ridge, or Nashville? And which commander should Generals on the Map cover next? Leave it in the comments.

Subscribe for more tactical breakdowns of the commanders who changed how wars are fought.

#GeorgeThomas #CivilWar #Chickamauga

Tags (paste into YouTube's tag box)

military history, history documentary, American Civil War, Civil War, Battle of Chickamauga, Missionary Ridge, Battle of Nashville, Chattanooga campaign, Horseshoe Ridge, George H. Thomas, Rock of Chickamauga, Ulysses S. Grant, John Bell Hood, Braxton Bragg, James Longstreet, William Rosecrans, greatest military tactics, animated battle map

18 tags · 342 of 500 characters.

Checklist (packaging guide §7)

DONE · Topic validated (research/VIDEO_IDEAS_v2.md #4: no competitor covers Thomas in this format)

TO DO · Competitor refs saved in youtube/competitor_refs/ (not done for this video)

DONE · Title scored ≥ 85 (91); hook in the first 54 characters; 91 characters; clear and true (relief order drafted Dec 9, battle Dec 15-16)

DONE · No negation in title or thumbnail

DONE · Thumbnail A completes the title: ONE DAY LEFT (before Grant replaced him) over the army he then crushed at Nashville

DONE · 3 thumbnail options for Test & compare: A ONE DAY LEFT (type 3), B "WE WILL HOLD" (type 1, verbatim quote), C HOLD THE RIDGE (type 1); labels and tags checked: spelled right, geography plausible, no anachronistic equipment

DONE · No links anywhere in the description (owner: links get new channels flagged as spam); licences named without URLs

DONE · Description in the owner's long format (hook, story, moves, method, "what this episode covers", chapters, sources, note on the numbers, credits, comment questions); 4,805 of 5,000 characters; names and numbers are in the voice or in research/FACT_NOTES.md

DONE · Chapters from timing.json paragraph starts (final audio); start at 0:00; all ≥ 10 s (shortest 47 s)

DONE · Credits + email placeholder + 3 hashtags

DONE · 18 tags, 342 characters; category Education

TO DO · Business email: the owner must fill it in